

Lab 1 Prep — Repository, Data, and the Raw GitHub URL

In Lab 1 (Week 5), we begin applying the Chapter 4 toolkit — unit root testing, ARIMA, and SARIMA — to a real dataset in Python. This is also the first entry in a repository that will grow with a new folder for every lab session this semester.

Complete every step below before lab day. We will walk through the Python analysis together live in Positron, so lab time should start with your repository already set up and your data already committed — not spent creating accounts or troubleshooting Git.

CREATE YOUR LAB REPOSITORY

This is separate from your personal website repository from Lab 0.

1.1 On GitHub

1. Go to github.com and click New repository.
2. Name it something clear, e.g. [ECON-5371-lab](#).
3. Visibility: Public.
4. Initialize the repository with a README.md (check the box GitHub offers) — we'll edit it shortly.
5. Click Create repository.

1.2 Clone it to your laptop

Use the GitHub Desktop App to clone it to your HD.

Remember the location.

SET UP TODAY'S LAB FOLDER

Create a folder for today, such as [lab_1](#).

DOWNLOAD AND COMMIT TODAY'S FILES

Download the [.csv](#) and [.py](#) file from Blackboard or [ncachanosky/ECON-5371-lab](#)

Commit and push the files to your lab repo.

FIND YOUR RAW GITHUB URL

Python needs to read the actual file contents — not the GitHub page that displays them. These are two different URLs.

1.3 Two kinds of GitHub URL

URL type	Looks like	Use for
Normal (viewer)	github.com/user/repo/blob/main/...	Browsing in a browser
Raw (file content)	raw.githubusercontent.com/user/repo/main/...	Reading in Python

1.4 How to get it

1. On GitHub, open [lab_1/gdp_synthetic.csv](#) (click the file from your repository's file list).
2. Click the Raw button near the top of the file preview.
3. Copy the URL from your browser's address bar. It will look like this, with your own username and repo name in place of the placeholders:

```
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/yourusername/ECON5371-labs/main/lab_1/gdp_synthetic.csv
```

Common mistake

Pasting the normal `github.com/.../blob/...` URL into pandas returns an HTML page, not a CSV — you'll get a confusing parsing error. Always use the `raw.githubusercontent.com` form.

BRING THIS URL TO LAB

Save your raw URL somewhere, maybe in your README.md file? We'll paste it into the first line of Python together at the start of lab, so having it ready means we can start the actual analysis right away.

EDIT YOUR README.MD FILE

Remember to properly edit your README.md file at the end of the session. You can look at the course lab repo for sample wording here: https://github.com/ncachanosky/ECON-5371-lab/releases/tag/lab_1